

SPORTING MOMENT OF THE YEAR

India's historic victory over Australia in Hockey at Paris 2024

The Indian men's hockey team defeated Australia, the silver medallist from the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, 3-2 in its final Pool B match at the Paris 2024 Olympics. This was India's first victory against Australia in Olympic hockey since Munich 1972 – 52 years ago. Since then, the two teams had played each other seven times, with India losing five of those matches before their victory in Paris. India got off to a strong start, building a 2-0 lead by the end of the first quarter. P. R. Sreejesh kept the Aussies quiet for the most part. Australia narrowed the lead to 2-1 at half-time with a goal in the 25th minute. In the third quarter, Harmanpreet Singh extended India's advantage to 3-1 by converting a penalty stroke following a successful video referral. Australia fought hard in the final quarter and gave India a scare when Blake Govers made it 3-2 from a penalty stroke. However, India held its nerve to finish the group stage on a high note with a historic win.



Gukesh winning the Candidates

D. Gukesh became the youngest winner of the FIDE Candidates 2024 tournament and the second Indian to qualify for a World Championship final in the classical format. He held fellow title-contender Hikaru Nakamura to a draw in the final round and will face Ding Liren in the Championship final in November. The 17-year-old received a grand welcome at Chennai airport on his return from Canada, with fans and media gathering in the early hours of April 25. Amidst all the commotion, Gukesh spotted his mother and relatives and immediately went to embrace them.

